

Guitar Tunings Reference Guide

String order is shown low → high (lowest-pitched string first). Use a tuner and adjust string gauge/setup when moving substantially below standard pitch.

1. Standard, Down & Drop Tunings

Tuning	Notes	What it gives you
Standard	E A D G B E	The default tuning for most guitar music.
Half-step down / Eb Standard	Eb Ab Db Gb Bb Eb	Lower tension and a darker sound; useful for vocal range and rock.
Whole-step down / D Standard	D G C F A D	Heavier overall register while preserving standard chord shapes.
Drop D	D A D G B E	Low sixth string drops one tone; easy one-finger power chords.
Double Drop D	D A D G B D	Both outer strings lowered; strong drones for acoustic and folk.
Drop C#	C# G# C# F# A# D#	Half-step-down guitar with the sixth string dropped another tone.
Drop C	C G C F A D	A staple for heavy rock, metal and modern riff writing.
Drop B	B F# B E G# C#	Very low register; usually benefits from heavier strings.
Drop A	A E A D F# B	Extremely low 6-string setup; baritone scale length is often preferable.

2. Open Tunings

Tuning	Notes	What it gives you
Open D	D A D F# A D	Major D chord when strummed open; excellent for slide.
Open E	E B E G# B E	Open E major; similar shapes to Open D but higher tension.
Open G	D G D G B D	Open G major; rootsy blues, rock and slide vocabulary.
Open A	E A C# E A E	Open A major; bright slide and country-blues sound.
Open C	C G C G C E	Large, resonant acoustic sound with deep low C.
Open C minor	C G C G C Eb	Open C with a minor third for darker harmony.
Open D minor	D A D F A D	Open D minor; cinematic, folk and fingerstyle colour.
Open E minor	E B E G B E	Open E minor drone tuning.

3. Modal, Acoustic & System Tunings

Tuning	Notes	What it gives you
DADGAD	D A D G A D	Suspended/modal sound; ideal for Celtic, folk and ambient playing.
DADF#AD	D A D F# A D	Open D family tuning with a clear major-third sound.
CGDGCD	C G D G C D	Modern fingerstyle tuning with wide, ringing intervals.
CACGCE	C A C G C E	Low C and unusual inner intervals for percussive acoustic writing.

Tuning	Notes	What it gives you
CGDGAD	C G D G A D	Modal C-based tuning; useful for drones and open voicings.
New Standard Tuning	C G D A E G	Mostly fifths; broad range and unfamiliar but logical shapes.
All Fourths	E A D G C F	Uniform interval layout; highly consistent fretboard logic.
Major Thirds	E G# C E G# C	Compact chord shapes; experimental and systematic.
All Fifths	C G D A E B	Huge range; demanding stretches and often specialist setup.
Nashville Tuning	E A D G B E*	Same pitches as standard, but lower four strings use octave strings from a 12-string set.

4. 7-String Tunings

Tuning	Notes low → high	Details
Standard 7-string	B E A D G B E	Adds a low B below standard guitar.
Drop A	A E A D G B E	Low seventh string drops to A; common heavy 7-string setup.
Drop G#	G# D# G# C# F# A# D#	Half-step-down 7-string with dropped lowest string.
Drop G	G D G C F A D	Very low 7-string tuning; heavier strings required.
A Standard	A D G C F A D	Whole-step-down 7-string standard layout.
Half-step-down 7-string	A# D# G# C# F# A# D#	All strings lowered one semitone from standard 7-string.

5. 8-String Tunings

Tuning	Notes low → high	Details
Standard 8-string	F# B E A D G B E	Adds low F# and B beneath standard guitar.
Drop E	E B E A D G B E	Lowest string drops to E; powerful low-register riffs.
Drop D#	D# A# D# G# C# F# A# D#	Very low dropped setup; usually needs long scale length.
F Standard	F Bb Eb Ab Db Gb Bb Eb	All strings one semitone down from standard 8-string.
E Standard	E A D G C F A D	Whole-step-down 8-string standard layout.

6. Quick Selection Guide

Goal	Good starting choices
Heavier riffs without changing shapes	Eb Standard or D Standard
One-finger power chords	Drop D, Drop C or Drop B
Slide guitar	Open D, Open E or Open G
Ambient / fingerstyle	DADGAD, Open C or CGDGC D
Repeatable fretboard patterns	All Fourths
Wide-range experimental playing	New Standard or All Fifths

Setup notes

- Lower tunings need thicker strings to avoid floppiness, intonation problems and fret buzz.
- If you move below D Standard regularly, consider a longer-scale guitar or baritone guitar.
- Open E increases tension compared with standard tuning; Open D provides similar shapes with less tension.
- Always re-check intonation after a major tuning or string-gauge change.
- For app/tuner menus: Standard • Drop Tunings • Down Tunings • Open Tunings • Modal/Acoustic • 7-String • 8-String • Custom.